

EVEglyphDesign · Sovereign practitioner canon

Consultation Confidentiality & Referral Undertaking

A mutual, plain-language NDA for a first working conversation

Between the prospective client and EVEglyphDesign, under the Sovereign practitioner canon

Key ID EgD-KEY-2026-07 · Generated 2026-08-16T22:16:49Z · © 2026 EVEglyphDesign · Mutual.
Plain-language. Referrals free and standing.

Parties. The prospective client (the "Client") and EVEglyphDesign, operating under the Sovereign practitioner canon (the "Consultant").

This document travels with [Lillian's Guide — the Sovereign practitioner canon](#). It is intentionally short. It is written so a Client can hand it to their own counsel and see, in one reading, what it does and does not do.

The one sentence

Anything you say to us in consultation is yours; anything we say to you in consultation is yours to use; and if we are not the right fit, we will help you find someone who is, at no charge.

1. What this document is for

It covers a **first working conversation** — one or more meetings, calls, and shared documents in which the Client and the Consultant explore whether the Consultant should be retained. It is not an engagement agreement. If an engagement follows, a separate statement of work will supersede this document as to the engaged scope.

2. Mutual confidentiality

Each party will treat as confidential any information the other party marks confidential or that a reasonable person would understand to be confidential given the circumstances of disclosure. Each party will use that information only for the purpose of the conversation itself, and will protect it with at least the same care it uses for its own confidential information.

Nothing in this document restricts the use of information that:

- was already known to the receiving party without a duty of confidence;
- becomes publicly available through no breach of this document;
- is independently developed without use of the other party's confidential information; or
- is required to be disclosed by law or by a court of competent jurisdiction, in which case the party required to disclose will give the other party prompt notice where legally permitted.

3. Advice given is the Client's to keep

This is the operative clause and the reason the document exists.

Any observations, recommendations, references, methods, sketches, diagrams, or working advice the Consultant provides to the Client during the consultation are **the Client's to use**, whether or not the Client decides to retain the Consultant. The Client may act on that advice, share it with their own advisors, execute it with their own team, or hand it to another firm to execute — with no royalty, licence fee, or claw-back owed to the Consultant.

The Consultant retains authorship of the underlying methods and canon (including **Lillian's Guide**, the EVE reference model, and any published EVEglyphDesign artefacts). What the Client keeps is the **application** of those methods to the Client's situation as discussed in the consultation.

The Consultant does not condition advice on retention. If the advice happens to point at a different firm — because the fit is better there, because the timing is wrong for the Consultant, or for any other reason — the Consultant will say so and, where useful, help the Client find that firm (see §4).

4. Referrals are free, and standing

If, during or after the consultation, it becomes clear that the Client's need is better met by someone other than the Consultant, the Consultant will make introductions from its network at **no charge**. This posture is standing: the Client can come back a month, a year, or ten years later and ask the Consultant to help find the right practitioner or firm, and the Consultant will do so on the same no-charge basis, subject only to reasonable availability.

The Consultant does not accept referral commissions from the firms it introduces the Client to. Where such an offer is made, the Consultant will decline it or, if declining is not possible, disclose it to the Client and rebate it to the Client at the earliest opportunity.

If the Client ever finds themselves in trouble on a matter within the Consultant's competence — a failed programme, a vendor dispute, a data-sovereignty crisis, an urgent architectural question — the Consultant will take the call and give an initial view at no charge, whether or not the Client is a current or former engagement of the Consultant.

5. No implied engagement, no fees, no exclusivity

Signing this document does not create an engagement. No fees are due for the consultation unless separately agreed in writing before the work is done. Neither party is obliged to retain, refer, or use the other. The Consultant is free to continue serving other clients (including in the same industry) and the Client is free to speak with other consultants (including on the same problem).

6. Personal data

The Consultant will not collect, store, or process personal data of the Client's employees, customers, or counterparties beyond what the Client shares in the conversation itself. Where personal data is shared for the purpose of the consultation, the Consultant will minimise it, keep it only for as long as needed to conclude the conversation, and delete it on request. The Consultant does not train third-party AI models on Client confidential information.

7. Term and return of materials

This undertaking runs for **two years** from the date of signature. Confidentiality obligations survive termination. On request from either party, the other will return or destroy any tangible or electronic copies of the requesting party's confidential information, except for one archival copy retained solely for legal or regulatory record-keeping.

8. Governing law and forum

This document is governed by the laws of the Province of Ontario, Canada, without regard to conflict-of-laws rules. Any dispute arising from it will be resolved first by good-faith discussion between named principals of the parties, and if not resolved within thirty days, in the courts of Ontario, unless the parties agree in writing to arbitration.

9. Entire understanding for this stage

This document is the entire understanding between the parties for the consultation stage. It supersedes any prior oral statements about confidentiality of the consultation, and can be amended only by a writing signed by both parties. If any single clause is found unenforceable, the rest remains in force.

Signatures

For the Client

- Name: _____
- Title: _____
- Organisation: _____
- Date: _____
- Signature: _____

For the Consultant — EVEglyphDesign

- Name: _____
- In the lineage of Lillian, Sovereign practitioner canon
- Date: _____
- Signature: _____

A note in plain language, not a legal clause

We wrote this the way we did because we have watched too many first conversations end with a Client feeling that if they walk away, they walk away with nothing. That is not the practice. If we sit with you for an hour and say something useful, that hour is yours. Do the thing. Hire someone else to do it. Come back to us in ten years for a referral. None of it changes.

The practice is not the paper. The practice is standing behind the advice we gave you, whether or not we ever send you an invoice.

Pour le bien-être du peuple.